The climax *of Iron Man 3* brings together every piece of Iron Man gear in the Tony Stark catalog, all at once, against an army of genetically enhanced Extremis soldiers. The result is the biggest, wildest heavy-metal battle ever committed to film.

The first step in visualizing this epic conflict was the creation of keyframe art. "These illustrations were done very early in the film," Concept Illustrator Rodney Fuentebella says. "In fact, most of the armors were still being designed when I got this assignment. One of the main purposes of these keyframe illustrations is to create a sense of mood and inspire the rest of the production team in creating the final look. These days all the art is done digitally, to sketch a sense of action and staging. I created a rough 3-D mockup for some of the battle scenes before I painted them, to help me get an idea of the type of space I would like the battles to take place in.

"The Iron Legion flying into battle was a fun one. The drama of the multitude of armors all arriving to fight for Tony was an illustration I wanted to create when I first read the script. This is the arrival of Tony's army and the first time the audience is seeing more than one armor in battle—which is very exciting to me."




Art by Rodney Fuentebella.